

GREAT THINKERS (CONTINUED)

NAME	LIVED	ORIGIN	IDEAS/KEY WORK
St. Thomas Aquinas	1225–74	Italy	Greatest Medieval religious philosopher. <i>Summa Theologiae</i> (1259–69).
Niccolò Machiavelli	1469–1527	Italy	Argued that the state should promote the common good, irrespective of any moral evaluation of its acts. <i>The Prince</i> (1513).
Francis Bacon	1561–1626	England	Recognized that scientific knowledge could procure power over nature. <i>Novum Organum</i> (1620).
Thomas Hobbes	1588–1679	England	Father of English political philosophy, the study of how societies are organized. <i>Leviathan</i> (1651).
René Descartes	1596–1650	France	Overturned Medieval and Renaissance scholasticism. <i>Meditations</i> (1641).
Baruch Spinoza	1632–77	Netherlands	One of the most important 17th-century Rationalists, arguing that knowledge of the world can be gained through reason. <i>Tractatus Theologico-Politicus</i> (1670).
John Locke	1632–1704	England	Proponent of empiricism, the view that all knowledge of anything that actually exists must be derived from experience. <i>Treatises of Government</i> (1690).
Gottfried Wilhelm Leibniz	1646–1716	Germany	Mathematician and rationalist philosopher. <i>Monadology</i> (1714).
George Berkeley	1685–1753	England	Great empiricist who developed an idealist metaphysical system, maintaining that reality ultimately consists of something nonmaterial. <i>Principles of Human Knowledge</i> (1710).
David Hume	1711–76	Britain	Leading sceptic of metaphysics, the philosophy concerned with the ultimate nature of what exists. <i>Treatise of Human Nature</i> (1734–37).
Jean-Jacques Rousseau	1712–78	Switzerland	Proponent of the sovereignty of the citizen body. <i>The Social Contract, or Principles of Political Right</i> (1762).
Immanuel Kant	1724–1804	Germany	Sought to establish the authority of reason by critical examination. <i>Critique of Pure Reason</i> (1781).
Thomas Paine	1737–1809	Britain	Governments must respect the natural rights of their citizens. <i>The Rights of Man</i> (1791–92).
G. W. F. Hegel	1770–1831	Germany	Most influential of the German Idealists. <i>The Phenomenology of Spirit</i> (1807).
Karl Marx	1818–83	Germany	Radical social theorist and philosopher of Communism. <i>Das Kapital</i> (1867).
Arthur Schopenhauer	1788–1860	Germany	Espoused transcendental idealism, the belief that human experience of things consists of how they appear to us. <i>The World as Will and Representation</i> (1818).
Søren Kierkegaard	1813–55	Denmark	A forerunner of Existentialism, stressing the individual's unique position as a self-determining agent. <i>Concluding Unscientific Postscript to Philosophical Fragments</i> (1846).
Friedrich Nietzsche	1844–1900	Germany	Rejected religious and metaphysical interpretations of the human condition in favor of the principle of the "Superman." <i>Thus Spake Zarathustra</i> (1883–85).
Bertrand Russell	1872–1970	Britain	Founder of analytic philosophy, emphasizing clarity and argument. <i>Principia Mathematica</i> (1910–13).
Ludwig Wittgenstein	1889–1951	Austria	Most prominent analytical philosopher. <i>Tractatus Logico-Philosophicus</i> (1921).
Jean-Paul Sartre	1905–80	France	Leader of the Existentialist movement, which focused on the totality of human freedom. <i>Being and Nothingness</i> (1943).

MAJOR WORLD FAITHS

NAME	PLACE/DATE	ADHERENTS	FOUNDER	TEXT
Chinese traditional religion	Unknown, prehistoric	400 million	Indigenous	n/a
Hinduism	India, prehistoric	900 million	Indigenous	The Vedas, Upanishads, and Sanskrit epics
Shinto	Japan, prehistoric	3–4 million	Indigenous	<i>Kojiki, Nihon-gi</i>
Voodoo	West Africa, unknown	8 million	Indigenous	n/a
Judaism	Israel, c. 1300 BCE	15 million	Abraham; Moses	Hebrew Bible; Talmud
Zoroastrianism	Iran, 6th century BCE	200,000	Zoroaster	The Avesta
Daoism	China, c. 550 BCE	20 million	Lao Tzu	<i>Dao De Jing</i>
Jainism	India, c. 550 BCE	4 million	Mahavira	Mahavira's teachings
Buddhism	Northeast India, c. 520 BCE	375 million	Siddhartha Gautama (Buddha)	Pali canon, Mahayana sutras
Confucianism	China, 6th/5th centuries BCE	5–6 million	Confucius	The Four Books and Five Classics
Christianity	Israel, c. 30	2,000 million	Jesus Christ	The Bible (Old and New Testaments)
Islam	Saudi Arabia, revealed in 7th century	1,500 million	n/a; Muhammad is Prophet	The Qu'ran (scripture); Hadith (tradition)
Sikhism	Punjab, India, c. 1500	23 million	Guru Nanak	Adi Granth (Guru Granth Sahib)
Church of Jesus Christ of Latter-Day Saints (Mormons)	New York, 1830	13 million	Joseph Smith	The Bible; <i>Book of Mormon</i>
Tenrikyo	Japan, 1838	1 million	Nakayama Miki	<i>Mikigaurata, Ofudesaki, Osashizu</i>
Baha'i Faith	Tehran, Iran, 1863	5–7 million	Baha'u'llah	Writings of Baha'u'llah
Church of Christ (Scientist)	New York, USA, 1879	Up to 400,000	Mary Baker Eddy	The Bible; <i>Science and Health with Key to the Scriptures</i>
Cao Dai	Vietnam, 1926	8 million	Ngo Van Chieu	Cao Dai Canon
Rastafari	Jamaica, 1930s	1 million	Haile Selassie I	<i>Holy Piby</i>
Family Federation for World Peace and Unification	South Korea, 1954	3 million (official figure)	Sun Myung Moon	<i>Sun Myung Moon, the Divine Principle</i>
Wicca	1950s, but based on ancient beliefs	1–3 million	Gerald Gardner	n/a
Falun Gong	China, 1992	10 million	Li Hongzhi	Writings of master Li, including <i>Zhuan Falun</i>